Case Study: Strategic Planning at AEG Worldwide

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The emergence of AEG as a corporate manager in the entertainment industry has had a lot to do with the growth strategies implemented by the owner Philip Anschutz. Anschutz has seen large success in the business world because of his ability to diversify his portfolio and adapt to make educated decisions in a high-risk, high-reward sector. For example, "AEG is capturing at least part of the revenue streams from a lot of different places, which is a great model to have" (Schoenfeld, 2014, p5). Anschutz and AEG executives believe they are involved with the general consumption of entertainment around the entire world – having stakes in many different teams including the Kings, Galaxy, Dynamo, and other hockey teams in Berlin and Stockholm allows for all of the assets involved in AEG to be strategically allocated. This is especially important in a technologically advanced world where entertainment is constantly changing, meaning the stakeholders involved also need to be adapting over time.

The biggest key strategic planning decision that has contributed to the growth of AEG domestically has been Anschutz's willingness to take his own money and invest/risk it in real estate. Parking lots "which were valued at $35 a square foot when the Staples center opened in 1999 are valued at around $900 a square foot today" (Schoenfeld, 2014, p7). The entertainment industry being very volatile along with other contingencies such as social media presence meant that there was going to be inevitable risk involved in these business decisions made by Anschutz. Taking advantage of these opportunities and having the patience to watch his projects grow is what definitely led to the success of AEG as a sports empire. Furthermore, Anschutz's ability to effectively control different parts involved in the entertainment industry has allowed him to receive widespread public brand recognition. Since Anschutz was able to integrate AEG into the NHL, NBA, and MLS, he receives the support and enhanced brand

visibility from any one of these fans, even if they don't necessarily watch all three of those leagues. Globally, I think their expansion into London with the O2 arena in 2007 contributed greatly to the growth of AEG – creating this arena not only focuses on sustainability but also emphasizes that they care about providing their services to anyone who wants to access them.

AEG has the competitive advantage of being able to leverage their resources to constantly focus on their mission of growth, even if there is some risk involved. For example, AEG recently announced a realignment of international business operations which allows them to "achieve their ambitious strategic growth initiatives around the globe by ensuring our talent is focused on the right opportunities" (Pollitt, 2025, p1). What sets the top company's ahead of one another is their ability to take advantage of opportunities to continue improving their systems and operations. Since AEG has been focused on capitalizing on undervalued real estate dating back to Anschutz's time, they are continuously looking for new opportunities to expand around the globe and enhance their brand awareness.

AEG President Dan Beckerman has greatly helped the company grow and maintain their competitive advantage. This is mainly through maintaining the same growth-driven and expansion related partnerships/sponsors that Anschutz had been involved with during his leadership at AEG. Beckerman mentions "you have to pick your niche, have capital, have tenacity, and stick with it" (Vincent, 2025, p1). Understanding that the entertainment business is full of risks is very important for continued success at a company like AEG. I could see Beckerman exploring a stadium in the Asia Pacific after their new management strategy intends to "enhance its ability to meet growing international demand for live entertainment (Pollitt, 2025, p1). I think AEG has an effective growth strategy that Beckerman will uphold in the future.

References

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